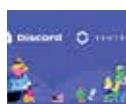




Google fined €500 million

Google is fined €500 million in France because they failed to negotiate fairly with news publishers. <https://digit.in/aug21-21>



Discord + Sentropy

Discord buys Sentropy - a company which makes AI tools to detect and remove online harassment. <https://digit.in/aug21-22>

global true wireless headphones market size is expected to reach \$18 billion by 2026, growing at a CAGR of over 20 per cent.

Wireless headphones have, no doubt, have improved considerably over the years since their inception. Bluetooth technology is now more robust than ever, advanced audio codecs such as aptX HD, LDAC, LDHC and others provide better data transfer rates leading to better sound, and the battery life on wireless headphones has also seen a significant bump. Additionally, technologies such as Qualcomm's aptX Low Latency codec also works at reducing the delay between audio and video when listening to wireless headphones.

There are also wireless headsets that allow you to experience the best of both worlds by providing an aux cable that you can use to turn your wireless cans into wired. Headphones such as the Sony WH-1000XM4, Bose NC 700, and a few others come with AUX cable support. However, the neckband-style wireless earphones and true wireless earphones don't usually have any kind of AUX support. There are exceptions where audiophile brands such as Audeze are coming out with hybrid headphones that can be used as wired or wireless.

Wireless headphones have definitely started dominating the audio market when it comes to new sales, with TWS and other wireless head-

phones taking over. While there are many wireless headphones that have intrigued us with their performance, we're still not ready to completely give up on good ol' wired. As a consumer, you need to decide what side of the fence you're on. If you're looking for value for money headphones, wireless is the way to go with the increasing number of features they have, but if you're an audiophile, high-end, wired cans are still supreme. Just don't go believing that ALL wired headphones are superior since an inexpensive wired headphone such as the boAt Bass-heads 900 still won't match up to the quality of good quality wireless headphones such as the Shure Aonic 50 or the Sony WH-1000XM4. [d](#)

BUYING ADVICE

Q Hi Agent001
Hope you and everyone in the Digit team is doing well.

I am thinking about buying a gaming laptop, but I'm not sure how much to spend. I'm planning between ₹50k to ~1 lakh.

I'm not a big fan of online gaming. Nor a pro player. Want to play most of the AAA titles (casual gaming) and would use the laptop to do some graphics designing using CorelDRAW, Photoshop, Illustrator, etc.

My main confusion is which budget (and specs) will suit my needs and which budget will be overkill. So could you please suggest to me the right amount of money and specs that I should think of investing in along with some good models?

PS: I definitely don't want a PC.

—Aravind Ram

A Hey Aravind,
Your priorities seem to be centered around gaming with a bit of graphics work on the side so most

gaming laptops should be more than appropriate for your needs. If you wish to play the recently released AAA video games, then you would be better off with a desktop built for gaming but since you've mentioned that you do not want to go down that route, we'll look at laptops exclusively.

AAA games often make the best use of the most recent graphics technologies and APIs to bring forth life-like visuals, and they are by no means efficient. On the desktop, we would have recommended an RTX 3070 or 3070 Ti from NVIDIA or an AMD RX 6700 XT. The equivalent of

those graphics cards on laptops are outside your budget so we'll go for the next best possible option - an RTX 3060 based gaming laptop.

Models such as the Acer Nitro 5 (NH.QBCSI.001) priced at ₹99,999 on the Acer India store feature the AMD Ryzen 5 5600H coupled with the RTX 3060 and have 16 GB of RAM. This particular model even comes with a free Xbox Game Pass for one month. There's also the ASUS 2021 TUF Gaming F15 which ships with a similar configuration but uses an Intel Core i9-11900H instead of an AMD processor. You will have to stretch your budget by about ₹5,000, but it's definitely worth the money since those extra CPU cores will come in handy for your graphics work.

Most other brands will provide similar RTX 3060 based configurations for around ₹1,35,000 but they also feature slightly higher TDP on the graphics card and while those may also be RTX 3060 GPUs, they'll perform slightly better because of the higher headroom. [d](#)



Acer Nitro 5